

Basic Windows Hardening Checklist

- ☐ Secure admin credentials.
- ☐ Take backups of services and important files.
- ☐ Create a backup admin.
- ☐ Secure user & service passwords.
- ☐ Audit users and remove / disable unauthorized accounts.
- ☐ Set & enforce a password policy.
- ☐ Disable vulnerable services (if possible).
- ☐ Remove unneeded remote access services.
- ☐ Harden SSH / RDP
- ☐ Enable and configure the firewall.
- ☐ Enable logging and monitoring.
- ☐ Run a scan with Defender.
- ☐ Harden GPO, Registry, startup and Task Scheduler configurations.